Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

924
13 1.43%
Oct 15th, 2021

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1075
13.00 1.22%
Oct 15th, 2021

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

687
-9 -1.29%
Oct 15th, 2021

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

129.55
0.55 0.43%
Oct 15th, 2021

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

151.05
1.10 0.73%
Oct 15th, 2021

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1020
110 12.09%
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2201 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

723.50
-12.50 -1.70%
Oct 15th, 2021 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
November 21 USD/dmt

122.10
-1.60 -1.29%
Oct 15th, 2021 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2201 (Jan) RMB/t

5515
50 0.91%
Oct 15th, 2021 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

43.73
-2.32 -5.04%
Oct 14th, 2021

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

18.32
-0.61 -3.21%
Oct 14th, 2021

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

5840
-60 -1.02%
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

137.82
7.04 5.38%
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

15.11
1.08 7.72%
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

5780
10 0.17%
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Oct 15th, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	924	13	1.4%	916	1251	762	1680	133.86	2.00	1.5%	132.40	181.82	109.14	247.30
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	687	-9	-1.3%	690	1019	518	1421	99.53	-1.32	-1.3%	99.80	149.00	73.66	210.83
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1075	13	1.2%	1070	1455	952	1894	156.42	2.01	1.3%	155.42	212.19	133.20	278.61

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Oct 15th, 2021		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	129.55	0.55	0.43%	127.60	175.77	112.75	230.50
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	151.05	1.10	0.73%	146.23	203.05	131.15	262.95

MARKET COMMENTARY

As of October 15, the iron ore inventories across 35 ports tracked by SMM totalled 137.82 million mt, up 4.11 million mt from a week ago and 11.15 million mt from a year ago. The daily average deliveries from the 35 ports decreased 68,000 mt on a weekly basis to 2.59 million mt, the lowest in nearly two months. Recently, more imported ore arrived at Chinese ports. While the steel mills have returned the routine purchase on rigid demand after restocking ahead of the National Day holiday. As such, the increase in the port inventory has accelerated. In particular, the inventories in the two main ports in Tangshan area has increased the most, partly because the purchase demand of steel mills in north China has declined due to the recent "2+26" urban heating season regulation issued by the government. The delivery from these two ports fell greatly. In addition, major local ports have carried out short-term closure on frequent environmental protection management and control. Taking into account the recent decline in the departures from Australian and Brazil ports, the port inventory is likely to rise at a slower pace. DCE iron ore futures continued to fluctuate in a day, main contract closed 723, slightly decreased over yesterday. Some steel mills tend to buy due to suitable price while some traders were active to sell, with relatively stable price today. PBF at Shandong port dealt 870-880yuan/mt, an increase of 0-10yuan/mt over yesterday; PBF at Tangshan port dealt 880yuan/mt, decrease of 15-20yuan/mt over yesterday. The price difference between Shandong and Tangshan approaches gradually.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-oW	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1020	110	12.1%	1020	1493	886	1868	141.85	16.19	12.89%	141.85	207.70	118.00	262.00

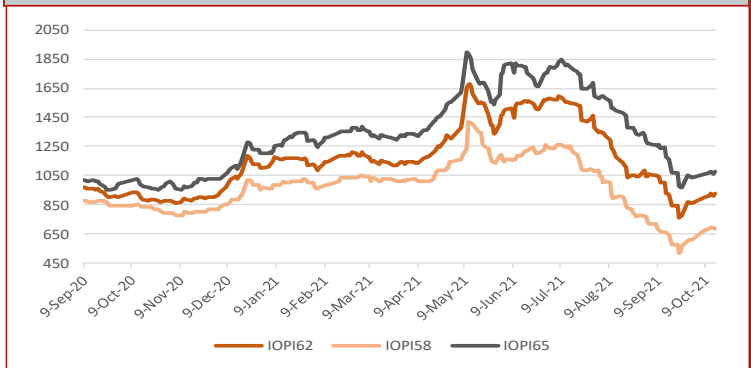
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	995	11.8%	779	1645	154.34	12.03%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1140	6.5%	780	1630	176.83	6.77%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	850	-3.4%	620	1310	131.85	-3.21%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1005	12.9%	865	1752	155.89	13.16%	122.55	272.32

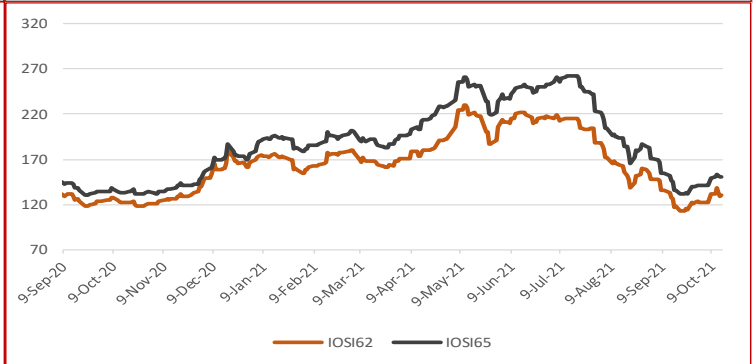
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	969.66	0.14%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.4934 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD 6.5044

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Oct 15th, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	1524	1519	1174	937	916	916	1251	221.54	170.18	135.90	135.31	132.40	132.40	181.82
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	1199	1186	894	648	690	690	1019	173.94	130.00	93.62	93.31	99.80	99.80	149.00
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1756	1750	1466	1152	1070	1070	1455	255.79	213.59	214.41	214.06	212.19	155.42	212.19

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Oct 15th, 2021		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	213.90	211.65	162.80	128.43	127.60	127.60	175.77
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	244.31	254.36	192.73	148.09	146.23	146.23	203.05

FREIGHT RATES

Oct 14th, 2021		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	18.32	-0.61	-3.21%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	43.73	-2.32	-5.04%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1735	1816	1409	1065	1020	1020	1493	245.23	254.64	196.49	147.90	141.85	141.85	207.70

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Oct 15th, 2021		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-237	-25.65%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	151	16.34%

Oct 15th, 2021		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	21.50	16.60%

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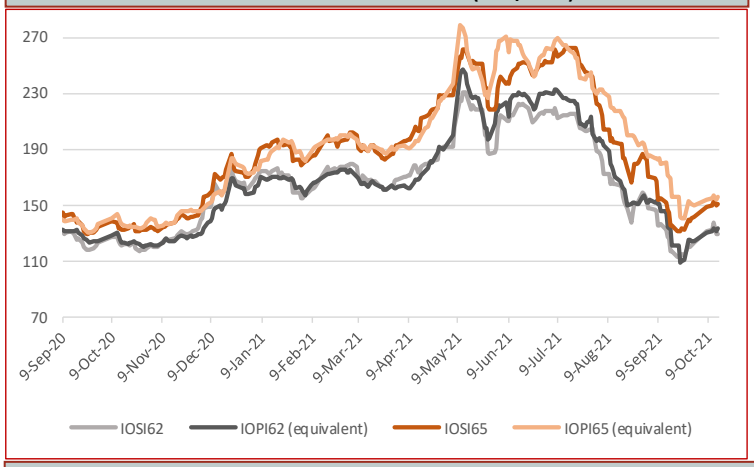
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Oct 15th, 2021	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	866	13	-58
SIMEC Fines	850	14	-74
PB Fines	891	13	-33
Newman Fines	939	13	15
MAC Fines	864	13	-60
Jimblebar Blended Fines	810	13	-114
Carajas Fines	1067	13	143
Brazilian SSF	920	13	-4
Brazilian Blend Fines	927	13	3
RTX Fines	802	13	-122
West Pilbara Fines	849	13	-75

Oct 15th, 2021	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	125.05	0.55	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	121.55	0.55	-8.00
PB Fines	128.30	0.55	-1.25
Newman Fines	129.45	0.55	-0.10
MAC Fines	125.45	0.55	-4.10
Jimblebar Blended Fines	118.80	0.55	-10.75
Carajas Fines	159.10	0.55	29.55
Brazilian SSF	133.30	0.55	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	134.95	0.55	5.40
RTX Fines	119.45	0.55	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	123.80	0.55	-5.75

Oct 15th, 2021	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	686	-9	-1
FMG Blended Fines	692	-9	5
Robe River	691	-9	4
Western Fines	699	-9	12
Atlas Fines	687	-9	0
Yandi	683	-9	-4

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	31.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	23.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	23.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	23.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	26.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	57.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	55.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	58.00	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	28.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	12.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	40.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	9.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	9.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	3.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	3.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	3.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	3.50	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	1.50	0.50
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	1.50	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	4.00	0.25
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	8.25	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	0.25	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-95.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	0.00	25.00	Jingtang	-25.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-95.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-40.00	0.00

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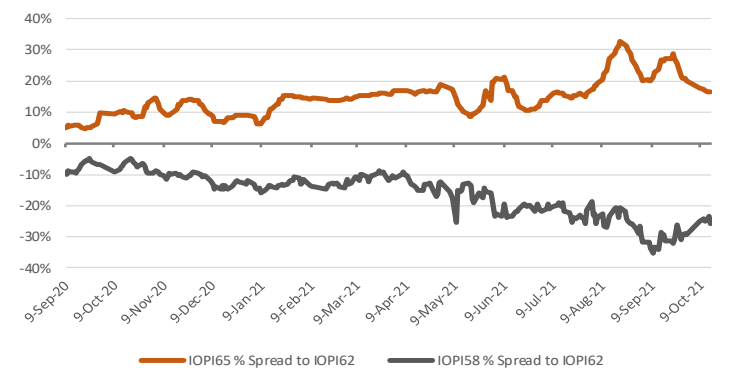
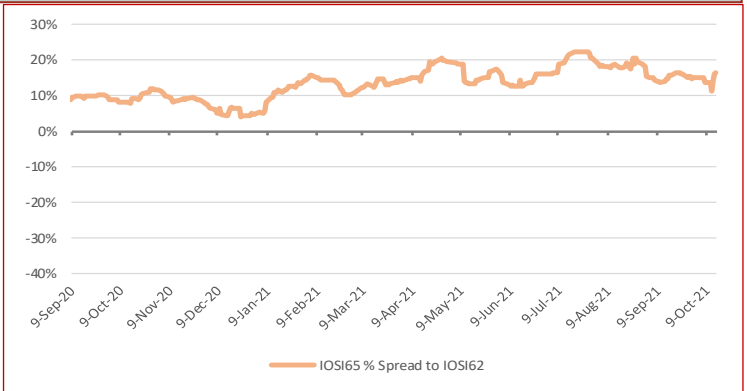
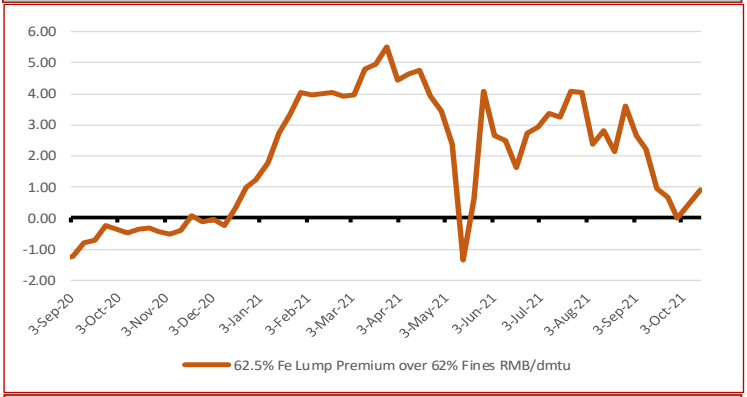
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

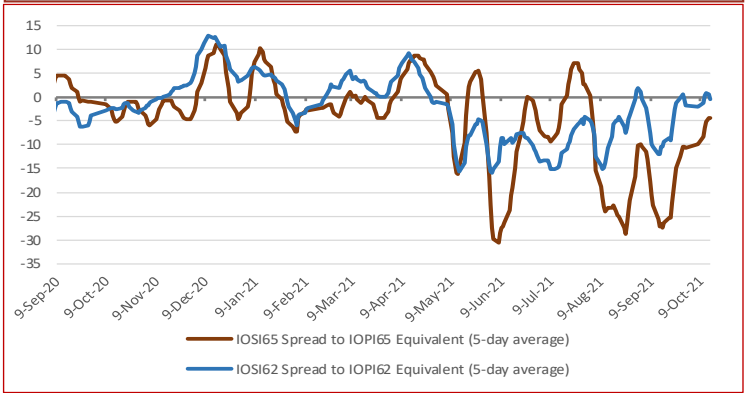




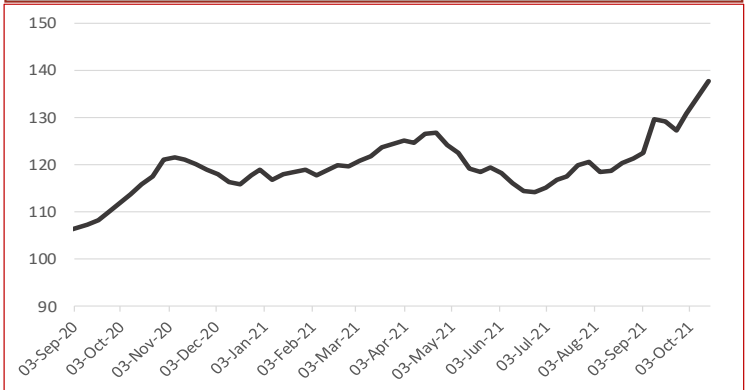
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



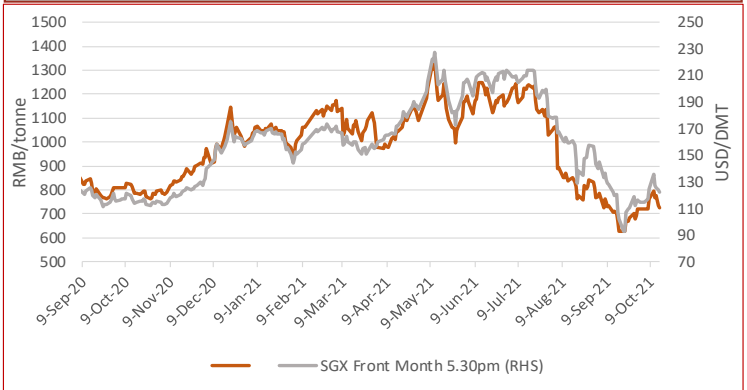
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

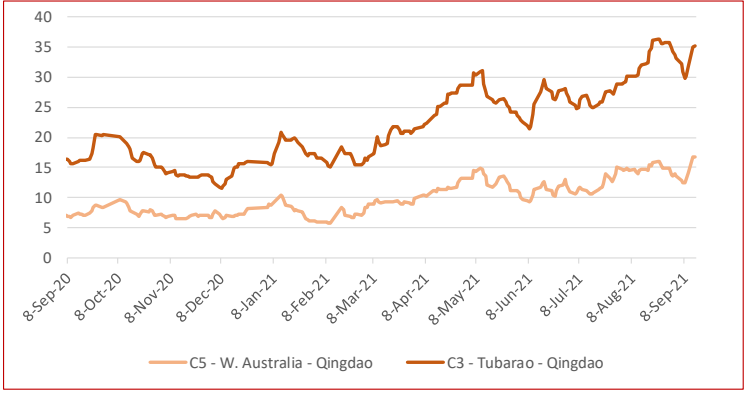
Week Ending Oct 15th, 2021

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	17.09	1.73%	12.26	19.20
Qingdao	22.77	5.03%	9.41	22.77
Caofeidian	13.41	10.64%	11.25	16.25
Tianjin	10.41	3.27%	7.14	11.28
Rizhao	14.01	6.06%	9.44	14.22
Total (35 Ports)	137.82	5.38%	98.80	137.82

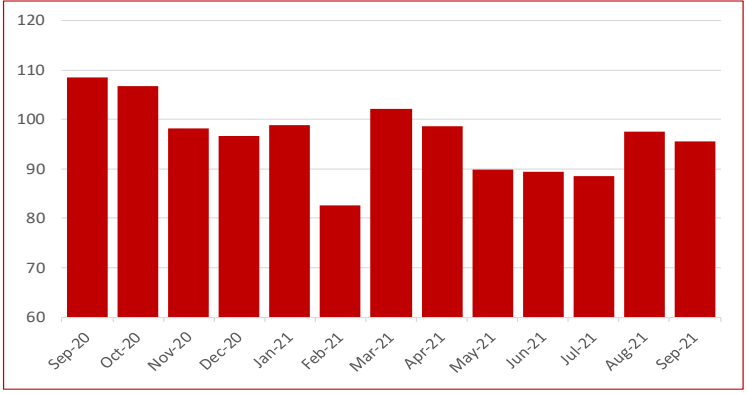
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Oct 15th, 3pm close			Oct 15th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2201	Change	Change %	Nov. 21	Change	Change %
Closing Price	723.50	-12.50	-1.70%	122.10	-1.60	-1.29%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	69.40	4.35	6.68%	2.65	-0.64	-19.35%
Open positions ('000 lots)	46.46	1.70	3.79%	17.87	-0.13	-0.75%
Day Low	714.0	2.00	0.28%	119.50	4.00	3.46%
Day High	742.5	-5.50	-0.74%	125.40	0.90	0.72%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2021/10/15	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	5,840	-60	-1.02%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	6,190	-60	-0.96%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	5,780	10	0.17%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	6,500	0	0.00%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	5,790	80	1.40%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	6,740	0	0.00%
Colour Coated Plate	8,900	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

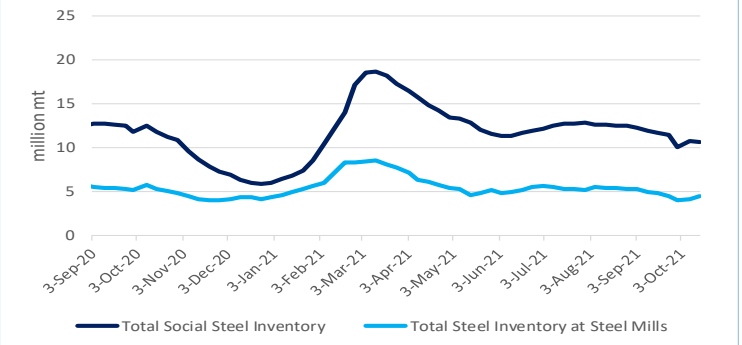
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	123.70	2	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	4,210	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,700	80	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	4,708	252	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	5,016	259	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	906	-321	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,988	252	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	782	-241	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

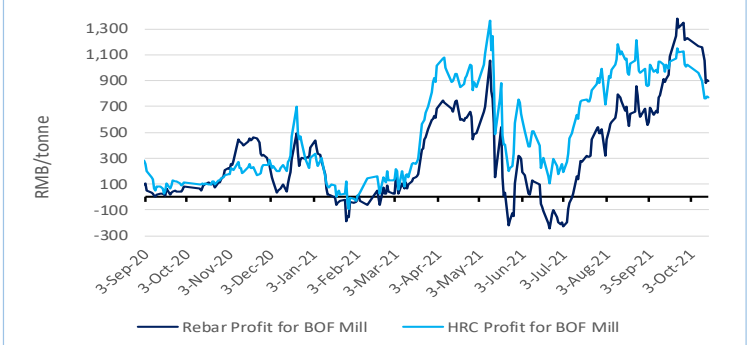
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

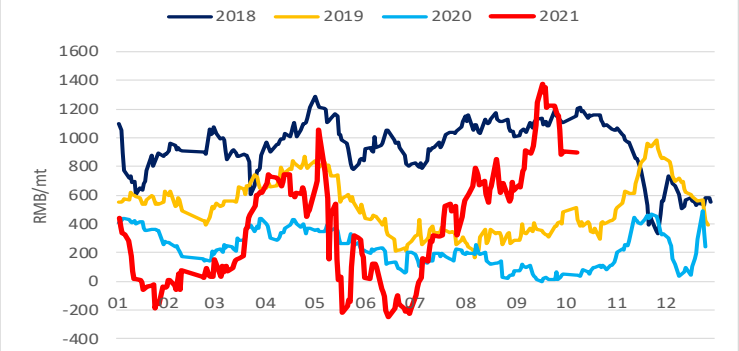
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



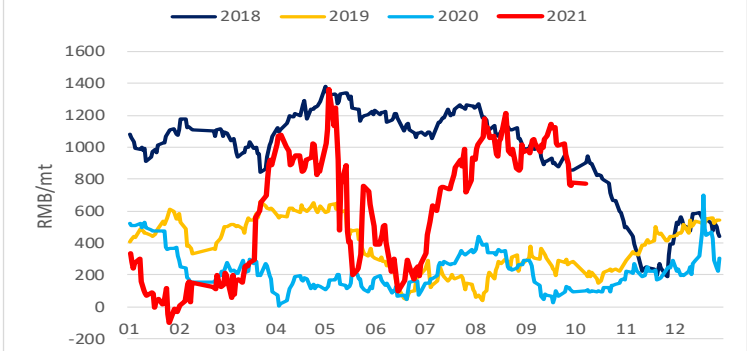
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



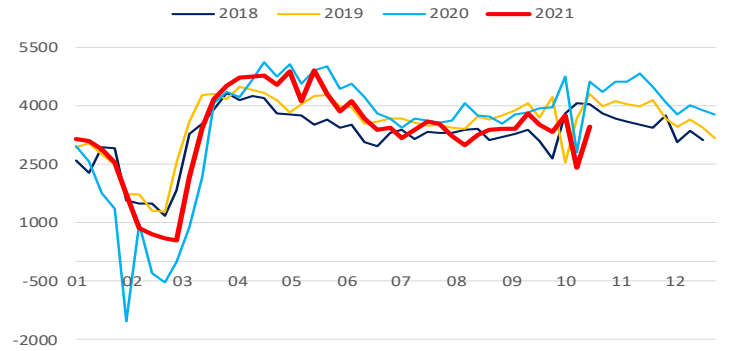
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



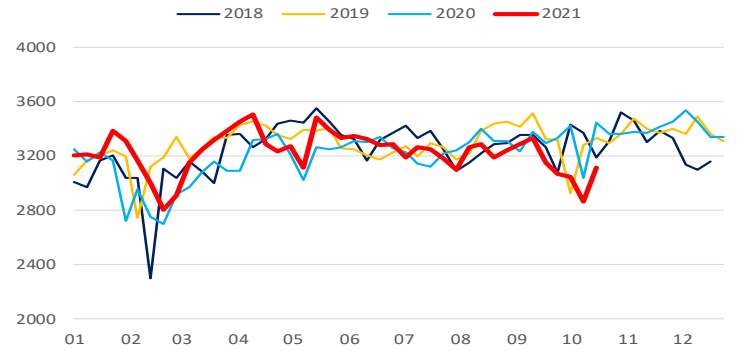
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



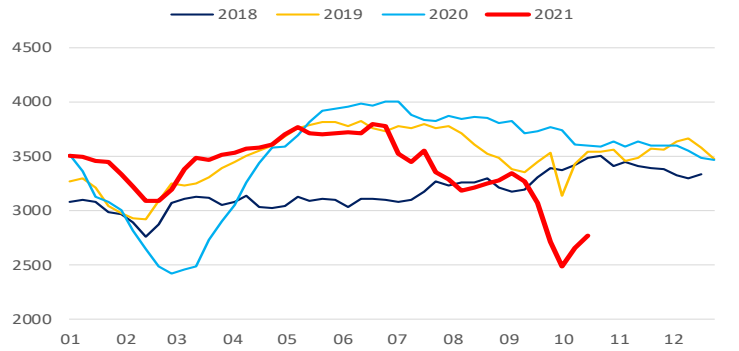
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



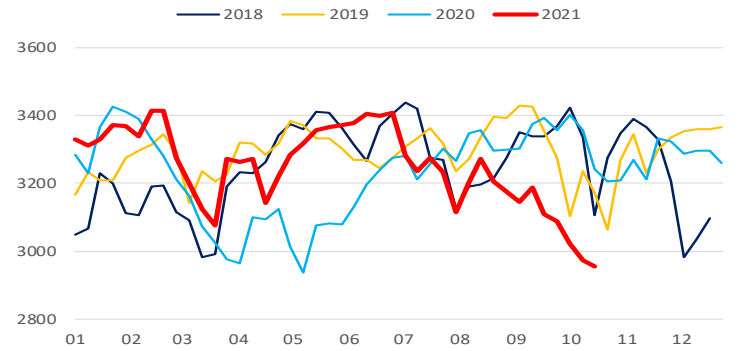
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Oct 15th, 2021	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Oct 15th, 2021	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.40%	0.090%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.70%	0.080%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.00%	4.50%	0.120%	8.00%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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